

HIST5706 Class 1 (Sept10)

- Digital histories is a way of connecting with audiences and building communities across boundaries of place/time; allows you to find your "people" for your project
- Agent-based modelling can be a tool of necromancy
 - giving models a set of behaviours according to a given set of cultural/social/historical norms, including individual-based characteristics in wide swaths
 - Idea a heterogenous set of agents will interact and something real will emerge out of it
 - if rules based on roman social customs, than what you produce has something to do with roman social customs
 - for example, can change economic conditions to see how people respond
- The process of learning in coding is just as much about the ways things break as what goes right... your practice is about a willingness to be vulnerable about your process, make mistakes
 - harder to do this when your identities/presentations are the subject of internet vitriol.
- Digital history as a way of connecting not just with the past, but with places humans have no business being, about access
- Digital humanities, like most subjects, has had its own turns/waves.
 - In 70s, criticized for turning people into numbers (too qualitative)
 - In 90s, web emerges and creates new possibilities
 - the valley in the shadow of death
 - "Name of the Rose" digital library with rooms that correspond with geographic relationships
 - In 2000s, phrase "digital humanities" is coined
 - about examining not only how we affect digitizing, but how it affects us back!
 - spreadsheets, for example, reveal so much about us and our choices. Our digital approach = our methodology
 - Look at acts of transformation, not just final product

FAIL GLORIOUSLY !!!!!

- Paradata is your embarrassing, real story of progress
- Can work in community
- Look at reviews in DH as a resource
- And relation between data/things is a network. What is missing can also tell you just as much

Our goal: avoid dead research and learn coding as a matter of literacy

My main take-aways:

- about the process of learning, revelations as we TRY
- the opportunity to learn in a safe environment where you won't get ripped apart for being a woman trying something online
- choices in digital history can be more revealing than final product and stated intentions

Personal notes

- I love the searchability and layout of Obsidian